

2026 UPDATE

ARC FLASH LABELING



Inside This Guide:

- Understand arc flash labeling requirements
- Reduce labeling errors and safety risks
- Standardize compliant electrical equipment labels
- Print durable arc flash labels on demand

DuraLabel®

1.877.534.5157
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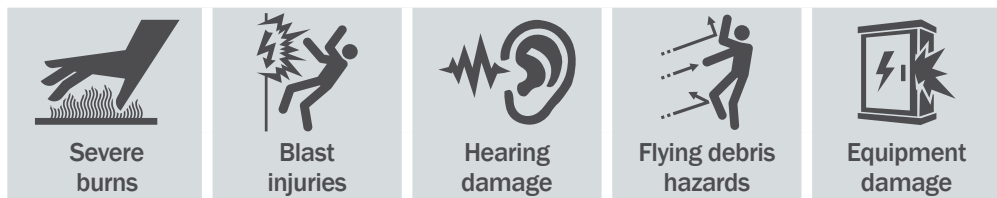


IDENTIFY ARC FLASH HAZARDS

Arc flash incidents present a serious electrical hazard in industrial environments. Without clear identification and labeling, workers may not recognize the level of risk before work begins on or near energized equipment.

An arc flash occurs when electrical current leaves its intended path and travels through the air. These events release extreme heat, pressure, and energy in a fraction of a second.

Arc flash incidents can result in:



Workers may be exposed to arc flash risk during inspection, maintenance, or troubleshooting when equipment remains energized. Because these hazards are not always visible, OSHA and NFPA 70E requirements make clear labeling essential to help workers identify risk before interacting with equipment.

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KNOW ARC FLASH LABELING STANDARDS

Arc flash labeling requirements help protect workers from serious electrical hazards and help ensure facilities communicate risk clearly before work begins. Without proper labeling, workers may not recognize the level of danger, increasing the risk of injury, equipment damage, OSHA citations, and potential liability.

Arc flash labeling is shaped by three key standards:



OSHA (29 CFR 1910 Subpart S)

Requires employers to identify electrical hazards, provide PPE, and use warning labels where necessary.



NFPA 70E

Requires arc flash risk assessments and field labeling for equipment that may be serviced while energized.



NEC 2026

Expands arc flash marking requirements to include more non-dwelling equipment, including equipment below 1,000 amps.

Electrical equipment likely to be examined, adjusted, serviced, or maintained while energized must be clearly labeled and kept up to date. These requirements form the basis for how arc flash labels are created, applied, and maintained throughout the facility.



ARC FLASH LABEL REQUIREMENTS

Arc flash label requirements are defined by NFPA 70E and reinforced by the National Electrical Code (NEC), Article 110.16. Generic warning-only labels are not sufficient. Electrical equipment must display clear, specific hazard information based on arc flash risk assessments.

NFPA 70E requires electrical equipment that may be examined, adjusted, serviced, or maintained while energized to be marked with an arc flash label. Label content must reflect actual operating conditions and be updated when changes occur.

Each arc flash label must include:

Nominal System Voltage

Identifies operating voltage and supports shock hazard awareness.

Incident Energy or Required PPE

Indicates the level of protection required before energized work begins.

 DANGER	
Arc Flash & Shock Hazard Present Appropriate PPE Required	
ARC FLASH HAZARD PROTECTION	Arc Flash PPE Category: 4
Nominal System Voltage: 12,500	☒ Arc-rated arc flash suit hood
Arc Flash Boundary: 40 ft.	☒ Hard hat
12,500 VAC Shock Hazard When Cover Removed	☒ Safety glasses or safety goggles (SR)
<u>Shock Protection Boundaries</u>	☒ Hearing Protection (ear canal inserts)
Limited Approach Boundary: 5 ft.	☒ Arc-rated gloves
Restricted Approach Boundary: 2 ft. 2 in.	☒ Leather footwear
	☒ Arc-rated arc flash suit jacket (AR)
	☒ Arc-rated arc flash suit pants (AR)
Equipment ID: Feeder L60-3	Date of Arc Flash Risk Assessment: 2/20/2026

Arc Flash Boundary

Defines the distance at which a worker could receive second-degree burns.

Date of Arc Flash Risk Assessment

Confirms the information reflects current system conditions.



- Arc flash risk assessments must be reviewed at least every five years or whenever major system changes occur, as required by NFPA 70E.
- Labels must always reflect actual operating conditions. Inaccurate or outdated labels increase the risk of injury and non-compliance.



BEFORE CREATING A LABEL

Accurate arc flash labels depend on verified system data. Verify that the information being used reflects current operating conditions and the most recent arc flash risk assessment. Reviewing key details helps reduce errors and supports compliance.

Before labeling, confirm:

System voltage is verified

Confirm the operating voltage matches current equipment conditions.



Arc flash boundary is defined

Verify the boundary reflects the most recent arc flash risk assessment.



Incident energy or PPE category is determined

Confirm the information needed for worker protection is documented and current.



Risk assessment data is current

Use the latest available assessment and verify it reflects any recent system changes.



Use data from the most recent arc flash risk assessment. Labels should never be created using assumptions, incomplete data, or outdated reports. Once these requirements have been verified, the label creation process can begin with confidence.

HOW TO CREATE AN ARC FLASH LABEL

Creating an arc flash label requires accurate system data, a clear format, and a consistent process. A repeatable approach helps facilities create compliant labels efficiently and reduce errors across multiple assets.



Step 1: Gather Verified Data

Collect current system information from the most recent arc flash risk assessment. Confirm all values are accurate before proceeding.



Step 2: Use a Standardized Format

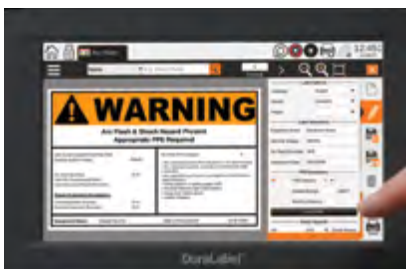
Use a consistent label format that includes all required elements. Standardization improves recognition and reduces confusion in the field.



Step 3: Design for Clarity

Ensure labels are easy to read and understand:

- Use clear headings
- Apply high-contrast colors
- Include a visible warning header, such as “DANGER”
- Keep layout clean and structured



Step 4: Create Labels Using Labeling Software

Labeling software helps standardize templates, reduce errors, and simplify updates across multiple assets.

Tools such as LabelForge® PRO Design Software allow facilities to input arc flash data, apply standardized templates, and maintain consistency across all equipment.



Step 5: Verify Before Printing

Confirm each label is complete and accurate:

- All required elements are included
- Values match the latest risk assessment
- Formatting and units are correct

CUSTOM SAFETY LABELS



LabelForge® PRO Design Software makes it easy to design professional, compliant labels. Built specifically for DuraLabel printers, it helps teams create safety signs, arc flash labels, pipe markers, and more—quickly and consistently.

- 3,000+ sign and label templates
- OSHA-compliant headers with symbols
- 2,000+ symbols across 40 categories
- Sequenced barcode Labels
- Templates for Compliant labels
- Included with all DuraLabel Systems

See How LabelForge PRO Design Software Makes Label Creation Easy

GET YOUR FREE DOWNLOAD ► [DURALABEL.COM/LFP](https://duralabel.com/lfp)

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HOW TO APPLY ARC FLASH LABELS

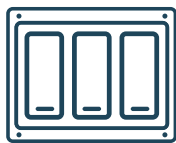
Arc flash labels must be placed on electrical equipment so workers can recognize hazards before interacting with energized components.



Equipment That Requires Labels

Electrical equipment where workers may be exposed to energized components during inspection, maintenance, or servicing requires arc flash labeling.

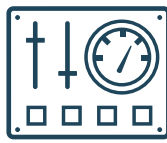
Common equipment includes:



Switchboards



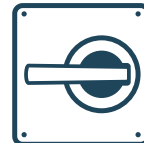
Panelboards



Industrial control panels



Motor control centers



Disconnect switches



Meter socket enclosures

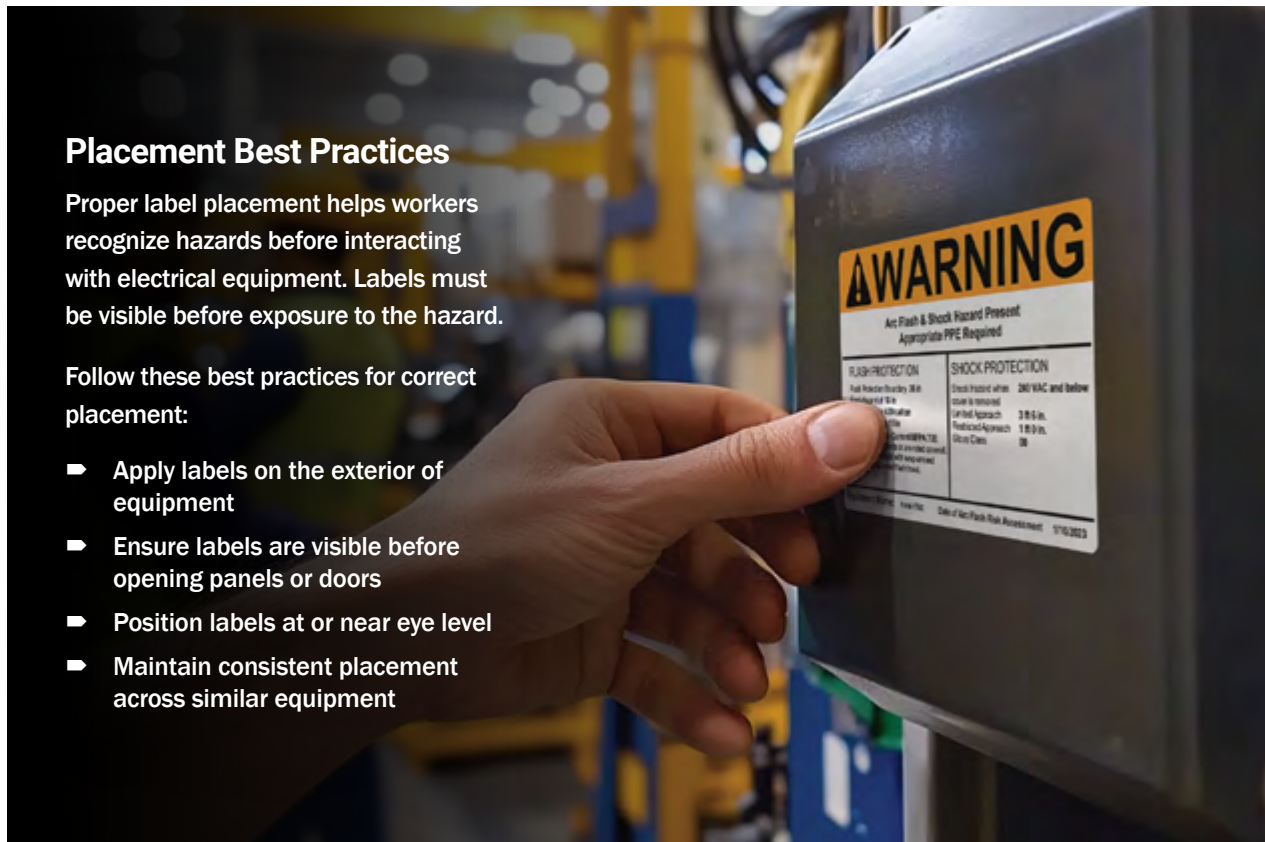
Arc flash labeling is now required on all non-dwelling electrical equipment that may be serviced while energized, including equipment below 1,000 amps.

Placement Best Practices

Proper label placement helps workers recognize hazards before interacting with electrical equipment. Labels must be visible before exposure to the hazard.

Follow these best practices for correct placement:

- Apply labels on the exterior of equipment
- Ensure labels are visible before opening panels or doors
- Position labels at or near eye level
- Maintain consistent placement across similar equipment



Durability Considerations

Labels must remain legible for the life of the equipment or until conditions change. Damaged or degraded labels can reduce visibility and increase the risk of improper hazard recognition.

To improve label durability:

- Use materials resistant to heat, chemicals, and abrasion
- Select adhesives appropriate for the surface
- Replace labels that are damaged or no longer readable



Maintaining compliant arc flash labeling requires more than accurate data. Facilities also need a reliable way to create durable labels quickly, keep information current, and standardize labeling across electrical equipment.



ARC FLASH LABELS: PRINT YOUR OWN

Keeping arc flash labeling up to date requires accurate data, durable materials, and the ability to update labels as systems change. DuraLabel® Industrial Sign and Label Systems combine LabelForge PRO Design Software, industrial printers, and long-lasting sign and label supplies—so facilities can create and update labels on demand, right where they're needed.



Industrial Sign & Label Printer

DuraLabel thermal transfer printers allow facilities to produce arc flash labels in-house for panels, switchgear, and other electrical equipment—reducing delays and helping labels stay current.



Easy-to-Use Label Creation Software

Built-in templates help create arc flash labels with compliance-required elements like voltage, incident energy, and PPE information. Generate accurate labels quickly using verified system data.



Tough-Tested Labeling Supplies

DuraLabel supplies are engineered for industrial environments—giving you labels built to stand up to chemicals, moisture, abrasion, and outdoor conditions.



Dedicated Account Manager

A dedicated account manager helps facilities select the right labeling solution and move efficiently from planning to implementation.



Lifetime Customer Support

Every DuraLabel printer includes lifetime customer support to assist with setup, updates, and ongoing labeling needs.

See why pros use DuraLabel for fast, easy printing.

► Visit DuraLabel.com to learn more or talk to a labeling expert at **877.534.5157**.

ARC FLASH LABELING CHECKLIST

Use this checklist to verify compliance and maintain accurate labeling across the facility.

Before Labeling

- ☒ Arc flash risk assessment is complete
- ☒ System data is verified and current
- ☒ Equipment is documented and up to date

Label Content

Each label includes:

- ☐ Nominal system voltage
- ☐ Arc flash boundary
- ☐ Incident energy or required PPE
- ☐ Date of risk assessment

Printing and Materials

- ☐ Labels use durable, industrial-grade materials
- ☐ Materials are suited for the environment

Equipment and Placement

- ☐ All required equipment is labeled
- ☐ Labels are visible and unobstructed
- ☐ Placement is consistent across the facility

Ongoing Compliance

- ☐ Arc flash risk assessments are reviewed at least every five years
- ☐ Labels are updated after system changes
- ☐ Damaged or missing labels are replaced
- ☐ Workers are trained to understand label information

If you left any of the above unchecked, your facility may benefit from a more standardized labeling approach.

Explore DuraLabel Systems ► DuraLabel.com



More safety resources are available at DuraLabel.com/resources



TAKE CONTROL



DuraLabel TORO[®] MAX INDUSTRIAL SIGN & LABEL SYSTEM

Print Arc Flash Labels In-House to Your Exact Specifications

Built for Compliance - OSHA, ANSI, IIR, NFPA, and more

Print in Seconds - Over 3,000 pre-made templates

Tough-Tested - Labels stand up to the harshest conditions

Fully Portable - Print anywhere on your jobsite

Easy Setup - Quick-load supplies reduce downtime

Free Design Software - Design & print in seconds



CLICK OR SCAN

FREE TORO MAX BUYER'S GUIDE

Learn how Toro Max helps teams create durable, compliant electrical safety labels in-house.

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